



STRATEGIC INSIGHTS

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1 Executive Summary

AIME 2025, held at the Melbourne Convention Centre, solidified its position as a leading platform for the Asia Pacific business events industry. The event, Melbourne Convention and Exhibition Centre, brought together 675 exhibitors from 30 countries, facilitated over 20,000 meetings, and welcomed 1,500 attendees, signalling a strong industry rebound and a vibrant future. The comprehensive Knowledge Program, curated with BEAMexperience and the show floor Ideas Academy presented by Spice, offered a diverse range of sessions, keynotes, and interactive workshops, addressing the most pressing issues and opportunities facing the sector.

The overarching message of AIME 2025 was one of **transformation and adaptation**. The event highlighted the profound impact of **Artificial Intelligence (AI)**, the urgent need for **sustainability**, the evolution of event design, and the enduring importance of **human connection** in a rapidly changing world.

KEY TAKEAWAYS



AI is Reshaping the Events Landscape:

AI is no longer a futuristic concept but a present-day tool with the potential to revolutionise event planning, marketing, and execution. From automating routine tasks to enabling hyper-personalisation and providing data-driven insights, AI offers significant opportunities for efficiency and enhanced attendee experiences. However, mastering prompt engineering and prioritising data security are crucial.



Human Skills Remain Paramount:

While AI will automate many tasks, uniquely human skills like emotional intelligence, critical thinking, communication, and creativity will become even more valuable. The future of work is about human-AI collaboration, where technology augments human capabilities.



Sustainability is Non-Negotiable:

The industry has moved beyond viewing sustainability as a “nice-to-have” and now recognises it as a fundamental business imperative. Regenerative practices, which aim to give back more than is taken, are gaining traction. The challenge lies in effective implementation and demonstrating the economic benefits of sustainability.



Event Experiences Must Evolve:

Attendees are seeking more personalised, immersive, and engaging experiences. Event organisers must leverage technology, design thinking, and data insights to create memorable events that foster meaningful connections.



Collaboration is Key:

The complexity of the modern events landscape necessitates greater collaboration between organisers, venues, suppliers, and technology providers. Strong partnerships are essential for innovation and success.



The Industry Needs Stronger Advocacy:

The business events sector needs to better articulate its economic and social contributions to gain greater recognition and support from governments and the wider public.



2 Key Themes

2.1 THE AI-POWERED TRANSFORMATION OF EVENTS

AIME 2025 made it clear that Artificial Intelligence is no longer a futuristic concept but a present-day reality reshaping the events industry. The discussions moved beyond basic AI literacy to focus on practical applications, strategic integration, and the evolving skill sets needed to leverage AI effectively.

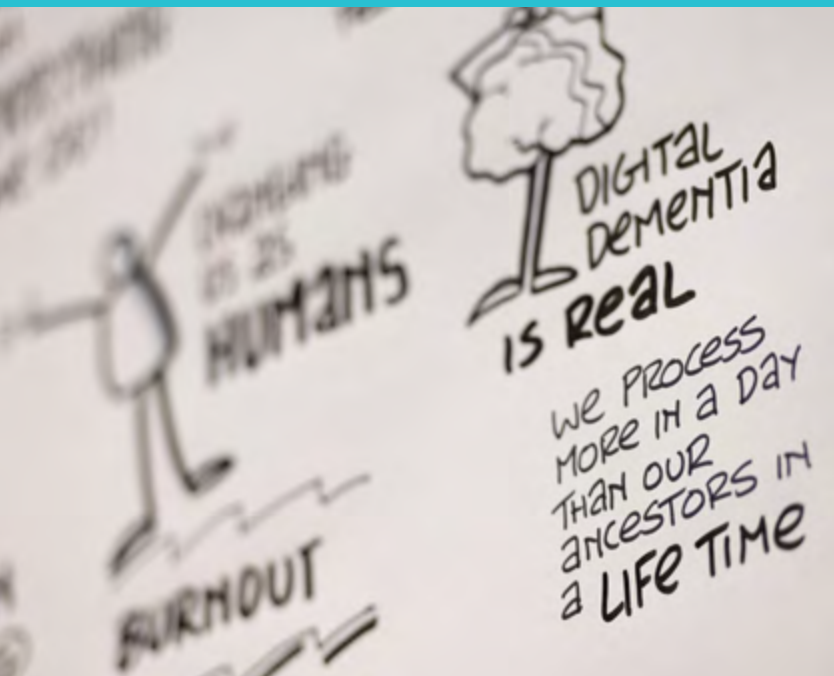
A core message was the need to view AI as a tool to augment human capabilities, not replace them. As Anne Jamieson, CEO of Saxton Speakers, stated in the PCMA APAC session, "It's about bringing the AI and the human together." This human-AI synergy was presented as the key to unlocking new levels of efficiency, personalisation, and creativity in event planning and execution.

Specific AI applications highlighted across multiple sessions included:

- **Content Creation and Curation:** AI tools like ChatGPT, Box AI, and IBM's proprietary content curation tool were demonstrated for generating event invitations, summarising presentations, and creating personalised follow-up content. As Miki Luong of IBM explained, "We created a tool which curated content for all of our attendees as follow up content. It saves us a lot of time because it automatically does it in seconds."
- **Operational Efficiency:** AI was showcased for automating routine tasks, such as HR inquiries (Ask HR), generating Q&A questions, and writing speaker bios (Spark). Daniel Tjan of Gevme emphasised, "We co-developed Spark with PCMA...for various tasks...creating session topics, generation of Q and A questions...to write bio descriptions, LinkedIn posts and press releases for example."
- **Event Marketing and Personalisation:** AI is enabling more targeted and personalised event marketing, from crafting tailored messages to recommending sessions and connections based on attendee profiles. Michelle Sargent, in the "Get Noticed!" session, highlighted this shift: "I think the key is that it's now become much more personalised...we're really getting as much information as we can from the delegate."
- **Venue and Speaker Selection:** AI tools are streamlining the venue search process, providing unbiased results based on specific criteria. Anne Jamieson mentioned, "The difference is that this will, it doesn't have the bias of only going to members like bureau members. It will look across the entirety of the Internet for you."
- **Sustainability:** Daniel Tjan introduced a groundbreaking sustainability hub, co-developed with GMAIC and Net Zero Carbon Events (an initiative born from COP26), which provides carbon footprint estimations and reduction strategies.

However, the importance of human oversight and critical thinking was repeatedly emphasised. As Leisa Hart stated in "Unleashing Human Potential with AI in the Workplace," professionals need to "learn critical thinking skills. This is your ability to test what's real and what's not real." The concept of "prompt engineering" – the skill of effectively communicating with AI – was presented as a crucial competency for event professionals.

Data security also emerged as a significant concern. Speakers cautioned against using free AI tools with sensitive information and advocated for enterprise-approved platforms with robust data governance. Miki Luong cautioned: "Don't put confidential data when you're using a tool like this. So, this is why we have Box AI. Box is within our enterprise approved application."





2 Key Themes

“85% of business success comes from emotional intelligence”
– EQ

2.2 THE HUMAN-CENTRIC FUTURE OF WORK

While AI dominated many conversations, AIME 2025 also underscored the enduring importance of human skills and connection in the events industry. The future of work was presented as a partnership between humans and AI, where technology amplifies human capabilities rather than replacing them.

Multiple speakers stressed the importance of ‘connection’.

Debra Panipucci and Leisa Hart, for example, said, “We actually think that there is more potential for the humans to do better work, more strategic work, build those connections and more of that face-to-face experience that you love and are so good at in the events industry.”

A key aspect of this human-centric future is the development of “soft skills” – or, as Vanessa Zamy reframed them in her session “Defibrillate Your Life to Reinvigorate Your Career,” “power skills.” Emotional intelligence, communication, empathy, and collaboration were identified as essential for leadership and team success. Zamy cited the Center for Creative Leadership’s finding that “85% of business success comes from emotional intelligence. EQ.”

Several sessions focused on specific strategies for enhancing these “power skills”:

- **Brave Conversations:** Sheila Vijayarasa, in “Small Steps, Big Impact,” emphasised the value of having difficult but necessary conversations to build stronger relationships and address workplace challenges.
- **Mindfulness and Self-Care:** Techniques like breath awareness, meditation, and purposeful leisure were presented as essential for managing stress and maintaining well-being in the demanding events industry. El Kwang & Tomas Jajesnica showcased: 3-2-5 breathing technique and a 10-breath counting exercise.
- **Neurodiversity:** Vanessa Zamy’s session on “Hacking Focus: Rewiring Productivity for the ADHD Mind” provided valuable insights into supporting neurodiversity in the workplace and leveraging the unique strengths of individuals with ADHD.
- **Generational Differences:** Speakers highlighted the “intergenerational workforce” and shared practical advice, such as Michelle Pascoe’s concept of “beep vs gobble” to encourage impactful communication. The overarching message was that, as AI takes on more routine tasks, the uniquely human skills of connection, creativity, and critical thinking will become even more valuable.



2 Key Themes

➔ ***“Sustainability is not good enough – we must be better than that.”***

2.3 SUSTAINABILITY: FROM ASPIRATION TO ACTION

AIME 2025 demonstrated a clear shift in the sustainability conversation, moving beyond mere awareness to a focus on practical implementation and measurable impact.

The concept of “regenerative tourism” – giving back more than is taken – was introduced by Mat Woods of Destination Queenstown. He argued that “Sustainability is not good enough...we must be better than that.” This reflects a growing understanding that the industry must not only minimise its environmental footprint but actively contribute to positive change.

Several key themes emerged within the sustainability discussions:

- ➔ **Economic Viability:** Speakers challenged the misconception that sustainability is inherently more expensive, highlighting how sustainable practices often lead to cost savings and new revenue opportunities.
- ➔ **Innovative Solutions:** Practical examples of sustainability initiatives were showcased, demonstrating the creativity and resourcefulness of the industry.
- ➔ **Collaboration:** The importance of collaboration, even among competitors, was emphasised as crucial for achieving industry-wide sustainability goals.
- ➔ **Generational Shift** Speakers addressed the generational shift driving sustainability initiatives, with over 50% of staff at some venues aged 18-24. This aligns with McCrindle Research findings, which revealed high expectations for sustainable events among younger attendees, including the emerging Alpha generation.
- ➔ **Measurement and Reporting:** With mandatory reporting on the horizon, speakers stressed the need for organisations to start measuring their environmental footprint and setting targets for improvement.

Nadine ToeToe of Kohutapu Lodge, Tribal Tours, and Fiinaki Forest Footsteps showcased the profound social and economic impact of indigenous-led tourism initiatives. She stated that they “pivoted to the only place we knew our young people - rangatahi - and we transitioned our lodge into a youth training facility. We ran 312 week long courses on site for our indigenous youth who were not in education, employment, or training.”



2 Key Themes

2.4 ELEVATED EVENT EXPERIENCES: DESIGN, ENGAGEMENT, AND PERSONALISATION

AIME 2025 showcased a strong focus on elevating the event experience through innovative design, immersive technologies, and a deep understanding of attendee needs and preferences.

Key trends included:

- **Immersive Experiences:** Augmented reality (AR), AI-generated artwork, and sensory-rich environments were highlighted as ways to create memorable and engaging experiences.
- **Personalisation:** Tailoring event content, networking opportunities, and even music playlists to individual attendee preferences was presented as a key to maximising engagement. David Wright shared how curating Spotify playlists based on attendees' preferences creates a more engaging atmosphere.
- **Evolving F&B Trends:** Event catering is moving towards healthier options, local and indigenous produce, and a greater focus on non-alcoholic beverages.
- **Rethinking Networking:** Event organisers are finding creative ways to integrate meaningful networking opportunities throughout the event program, recognising that connections are a primary driver for attendance.
- **Customer Journey:** Speakers showcased how customer segmentation informed the design of zones and thoughtful designs.



Speakers emphasised the importance of holistic event design that considers every aspect of the attendee journey, from pre-event communication to post-event follow-up.





2 Key Themes

2.5 MARKETING AND SALES IN A CHANGING LANDSCAPE

The sessions on event marketing and sales highlighted the need for adaptability in a rapidly evolving digital landscape.

Key takeaways included:

- **Multi-Channel Marketing:** Utilising a variety of marketing channels, tailored to the specific audience and event, is crucial for reaching potential attendees.
- **Video Content:** Video content, particularly featuring speakers or industry experts, was identified as a highly effective engagement tool.
- **Data-Driven Strategies:** Speakers like George Hawwa, founder of Attention Experts, delivered a masterclass on "Creating Social and Digital Marketing ROI for Meetings and Events in 2025. He highlighted the paradigm shift from vanity metrics to meaningful engagement indicators like Cost Per Mille (CPM), click-through rate (CTR), and "hang time."
- **Personalisation:** Speakers like Michelle Sargent from Events Beyond and Julie Allen from the Australian Institute of Mining and Metallurgy, emphasised the critical role of personalisation in today's event landscape, advocating for tailored messaging to boost attendee engagement.
- **The Rise of Social Media Search:** Social media platforms, particularly Meta, are becoming increasingly important search engines, requiring event marketers to integrate SEO elements into their social media campaigns.
- **Unique Placement Advertising (UPA):** UPA offers hyper-targeted advertising capabilities, allowing event organisers to reach specific audiences in precise locations.
- **The Sales Evolution:** The sales process is evolving, with a greater emphasis on building relationships, understanding client needs, and leveraging technology to enhance efficiency. Abbie White challenged attendees to "think again" about their sales approaches, embracing concepts like "intelligent failure" and "deep sales."



2 Key Themes

2.6 NAVIGATING CHALLENGES, UNVEILING OPPORTUNITIES

AIME 2025 underscored the need for a strategic and proactive approach to addressing the ongoing and emerging issues.

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- **Rising Cost:** Speakers and panels discussed the current state of affairs. Rising expenditures within the events sector, particularly in areas like hotels, air travel, and food and beverage, are impacting program design and destination selection. There is also a need for discussing and rethinking of venue selection. Gina Samuels and Tamara Cook emphasised the critical role of data-driven decision-making in maximising event budgets.
 - **Evolving Delegate Demographics:** The demographic of attendees for a particular event is changing. They are looking for valuable, tangible outcomes that can be brought back to the business. Speakers emphasised the need for diverse content and experiences.
 - **The Talent Crunch:** The ongoing talent shortage in the events industry was a recurring concern. Addressing this requires creative recruitment strategies, employee retention initiatives, and a focus on developing the skills of emerging professionals. Natalie O'Brien AM discussed her engagement with TAFE boards, while partnerships with universities like UTS aim to bridge the education-industry gap.
 - **Data Privacy & Security:** AIME 2025 highlighted the importance of data with the increase of technology and AI. Speakers like David Wright mentioned using an AI tool to overcome writer's block in event planning, while cautioning against over-reliance on technology.



3 Sentiment Analysis

The overall sentiment at AIME 2025 was overwhelmingly positive and characterised by a sense of excitement and forward momentum. Attendees and speakers alike expressed a strong belief in the resilience and adaptability of the events industry, viewing challenges as opportunities for growth and innovation. However, this optimism was balanced with a pragmatic awareness of the significant shifts and adjustments required to thrive in the evolving landscape.

KEY AREAS OF EXCITEMENT AND OPTIMISM

- **AI's Transformative Potential:** There was palpable excitement surrounding the potential of AI to revolutionise various aspects of event planning, execution, and marketing. The focus was on AI as a tool to enhance human capabilities, not replace them, leading to increased efficiency, personalisation, and creativity. The sentiment was one of embracing AI as a partner in progress.
- **Sustainability as a Core Value:** The shift from viewing sustainability as a "nice-to-have" to a fundamental business imperative was widely embraced. Attendees were enthusiastic about exploring and implementing regenerative practices, seeing them as both ethically responsible and economically beneficial.
- **Innovation in Event Design:** Speakers and attendees were energised by the discussions around creating immersive, personalised, and engaging event experiences. There was a strong desire to move beyond traditional formats and embrace new technologies and creative approaches.
- **Industry Growth and Recovery:** The strong rebound of the business events sector, particularly in the Asia Pacific region, fuelled a sense of optimism and confidence in the future. The reported growth figures and ambitious infrastructure projects underscored the industry's resilience.
- **Collaboration and Community:** The emphasis on collaboration, knowledge sharing, and building strong relationships within the industry fostered a positive and supportive atmosphere. The sense of community was palpable, with attendees eager to learn from each other and work together to address common challenges.
- **Indigenous Tourism:** Attendees responded very well to Nadine ToeToe's session. It provided a new standard for indigenous-led, sustainable & transformative tourism.





3 Sentiment Analysis

KEY AREAS OF CONCERN OR CHALLENGE

- **AI Anxiety and the Skills Gap:** While excited about AI's potential, some attendees expressed anxieties about job security and the need to acquire new skills to effectively utilise AI tools. The "skills gap" was a recurring concern, highlighting the need for training and development initiatives.
- **Data Privacy and Ethical Considerations:** The increasing use of AI and data analytics raised concerns about data security, privacy, and ethical implications. Speakers and attendees emphasised the need for responsible data handling and transparent practices.
- **Budgetary Pressures:** The rising costs of event production, coupled with increasing attendee expectations, presented a significant challenge for event organisers. Balancing cost-effectiveness with delivering exceptional experiences was a recurring theme.
- **Implementation Gap for Sustainability:** While the commitment to sustainability was strong, many acknowledged the practical challenges of implementing sustainable practices and demonstrating their ROI.
- **Industry Representation and Advocacy:** Concerns were raised about the inadequate recognition and classification of the events industry in official statistics and government frameworks. There was a call for stronger advocacy and unified representation.
- **Keeping Up with the Pace of Technological Advancements:** Speakers, such as Dr. Kristy Goodwin, emphasised: "Technology is evolving at rapid rates, but what has not evolved at the same pace is our human operating system, our HOS."



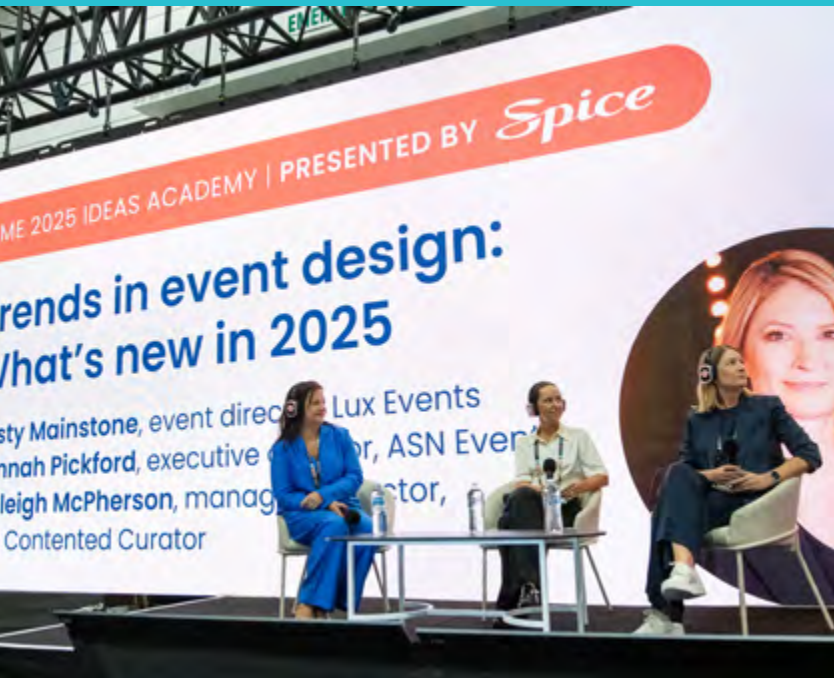
Despite these concerns, the overall sentiment remained optimistic. The challenges were largely viewed as opportunities for learning, adaptation, and innovation. The events industry demonstrated a proactive and forward-thinking approach, with a strong desire to embrace change and shape a positive future.





4 Opportunities and Challenges

AIME 2025 presented a clear picture of both the significant opportunities and the pressing challenges facing the events industry. The ability to successfully navigate these will determine the industry's trajectory in the coming years.



4.1. OPPORTUNITIES

- **AI-Driven Efficiency and Personalisation:** AI tools offer unprecedented opportunities to streamline event planning processes, automate routine tasks, and personalise attendee experiences. This can lead to significant cost savings, increased productivity, and improved attendee satisfaction. Early adopters of AI, who master prompt engineering and critical thinking skills, will have a competitive advantage.
- **Sustainability as a Competitive Advantage:** Embracing sustainable and regenerative practices is no longer just an ethical imperative but a business opportunity. Organisations that prioritise sustainability can attract environmentally conscious clients, enhance their brand reputation, and potentially achieve cost savings through resource efficiency.
- **Content Repurposing and New Revenue Streams:** AI tools enable efficient repurposing of event content (e.g., turning presentations into blog posts, microlearning courses, social media snippets). This extends the value of events beyond the physical gathering and creates new revenue opportunities.
- **Strengthening Industry Collaboration:** AIME 2025 highlighted the power of collaboration between venues, suppliers, organisers, and technology providers. Fostering stronger partnerships can lead to innovation, resource sharing, and collective problem-solving.
- **Expanding into Growth Markets:** The Asia Pacific region presents significant growth opportunities, particularly in emerging markets like India, Vietnam, and the Philippines.
- **Elevating the Attendee Experience:** The focus on creating immersive, personalised, and engaging event experiences presents an opportunity to differentiate events and attract a wider audience. This includes incorporating interactive technologies, thoughtful design elements, and catering to diverse needs and preferences.
- **Leveraging Data for Strategic Decision-Making:** The increasing availability of event data, coupled with AI-powered analytics tools, provides opportunities for data-driven decision-making, optimising event design, marketing, and overall ROI.
- **Indigenous Tourism:** The event set a new standard for indigenous-led, sustainable, and transformative tourism practices.



4 Opportunities and Challenges

4.2. CHALLENGES

- **Addressing AI Anxiety and the Skills Gap:**
Overcoming fear and resistance to AI adoption requires proactive communication, training, and demonstrating the benefits of human-AI collaboration. The industry needs to invest in upskilling and reskilling initiatives to bridge the skills gap, particularly in areas like AI literacy, prompt engineering, and data analysis.
- **Balancing Technology and the Human Touch:**
While embracing technology, the industry must ensure that it doesn't overshadow the importance of human connection and personalised interactions. Maintaining the "human element" is crucial for creating meaningful event experiences.
- **Managing Rising Costs and Budgetary Constraints:**
Event organisers face the challenge of delivering exceptional experiences while navigating rising costs and potentially limited budgets. This requires creative cost-saving strategies, strategic venue selection, and a focus on maximising ROI.
- **Data Security and Ethical Considerations:**
The increasing reliance on data and AI necessitates a strong focus on data security, privacy, and ethical considerations. Organisations must implement robust data governance policies and ensure compliance with relevant regulations.
- **Sustainability Implementation Gap:**
Translating sustainability aspirations into concrete actions requires addressing practical challenges, such as finding cost-effective sustainable solutions and measuring the impact of sustainability initiatives.
- **Industry Representation and Advocacy:**
The events industry needs to strengthen its voice and advocate for greater recognition and support from governments and other stakeholders. This includes addressing the misclassification of event professionals in official statistics.
- **Keeping up with the pace of technological advancements:**
Speakers emphasised the importance of constant learning and adapting to the fast technological changes.
- **Multi-Generational Workforce:**
The industry must manage a multi-generational workforce and adapt to their differences.
- **Cyber Security:**
Security was highlighted by multiple speakers as a growing threat, with a need for robust security standards.



5 Strategic Insights and Recommendations

This section provides targeted, actionable recommendations for key stakeholder groups, drawing directly from the insights and discussions at AIME 2025.





5 Strategic Insights and Recommendations

5.1 FOR EVENT ORGANISERS

- **Operationalise AI for Efficiency and Personalisation:** Go beyond discussing AI and actively implement it. Start by adopting tools like Spark (highlighted by Daniel Tjan of Gevme) for content creation, automating Q&A generation, and crafting speaker bios. Explore IBM's approach with Uncharted and AI Summit to develop tailored event strategies. Begin incorporating AI-driven post-event survey analysis, as Anne Jamieson suggested, to unlock deeper insights into attendee sentiment and preferences. The goal is to, as Miki Luong of IBM put it, use AI to "curate content...saving a lot of time" and freeing up human resources.
- **Master Prompt Engineering as a Core Competency:** Recognise that effective AI use hinges on skilled prompt engineering. Invest in training your team, creating internal workshops and encouraging experimentation, similar to what was discussed by Brooke Byrne and Miki Luong of IBM. Treat prompt engineering as a core skill, like creative communication, understanding that, as Miki Luong stated, "everyone in this room has the natural competency to be very good prompt engineers." Explore available resources like courses in LinkedIn.
- **Prioritise Data-Driven Decision-Making, Balanced with Human Insight:** Utilise AI-powered analytics to track event metrics (attendee demographics, behaviour, engagement), but combine this quantitative data with qualitative feedback and on-site observations. As Julie Allen of the Australian Institute of Mining and Metallurgy emphasised, true event success is measured by "how it feels on site. Does it have good energy? Is there a good vibe?". Aim to implement post event surveys.
- **Embrace the "Connections, Not Content" Paradigm:** Redesign your event programs to prioritise meaningful networking and interaction. As Ian Whitworth, Founder of Scene Change, put it, "connections, not content" should be the focus. This might involve incorporating longer breaks, interactive sessions, and dedicated networking spaces. Consider using AI-powered matchmaking services to enhance connection opportunities.
- **Champion Sustainability and Regenerative Practices:** Move beyond basic sustainability to embrace regenerative practices – aiming to give back more than you take. Follow the example of venues like Te Pai Christchurch (Gillian Officer) and ICC Sydney (Samantha Glass) by implementing waste reduction programs, partnering with local suppliers, and setting ambitious goals like carbon net-zero certification. Integrate the message from Mat Woods of Destination Queenstown: "Sustainability is not good enough...we must be better than that." Consider also, how you can incorporate Indigenous Tourism into your events.
- **Become adept at communicating with and leading a multi-generational workforce:** Adapt communication to generational preferences. As El Kwang said "We communicate with suppliers, partners, stakeholders, team members, part timers, freelancers on business and strategic matters. So, we cannot underestimate the need to be good at communicating."
- **Build a thriving culture:** Introduce tools like the ASS approach (Assume positive intent, Suspend judgment, Seek to understand) and the SBI (Situation, Behaviour, Impact) feedback model, as suggested by Shelly McElroy.



5 Strategic Insights and Recommendations

5.2 FOR VENUES

- **Become an AI-Ready Venue:** Prepare your infrastructure and systems for a future where AI agents are a significant customer segment. As Debra Panipucci and Leisa Hart projected, “AI agents will become a key customer base.” This means updating booking systems to accommodate automated research, booking, and rescheduling requests from these AI agents.
- **Invest in Sustainable Infrastructure and Operations:** Strive for certifications like carbon net-zero and implement comprehensive waste management programs. Follow the lead of venues like Te Pai Christchurch, highlighted by Gillian Officer, and ICC Sydney, showcased by Samantha Glass, in adopting innovative, sustainable practices.
- **Design for Flexibility and Inclusivity:** Create spaces that can accommodate a variety of event formats and cater to the needs of all attendees, including neurodivergent individuals. As Megan Peters, CEO of Lateral Events, noted, providing “neurodivergent rooms, quiet spaces” is becoming increasingly common and expected.
- **Offer Technology Integration Support:** Provide robust Wi-Fi, support for augmented reality applications, and readily available technical assistance to facilitate seamless technology integration for event organisers.

5.3 FOR SUPPLIERS (TECHNOLOGY PROVIDERS, CATERERS, AV, ETC.)

- **Develop AI-Powered Solutions Specific to Events:** Focus on creating AI tools that directly address the unique needs and pain points of event organisers. This could include solutions for content creation, attendee matching, data analysis, or sustainability planning.
- **Prioritise Data Security and Ethical AI:** Build trust by ensuring your AI solutions are developed and deployed with robust data security measures and adhere to ethical guidelines. As Daniel Tjan of Gevme put it, “If you are unable to trust the LLMs (Large Language Model) and what it’s doing with the data, I think it’s very hard for people to adopt it.”
- **Offer Sustainable Products and Services:** Respond to the growing demand for environmentally responsible events by developing and promoting sustainable options.
- **Build Strong Client Relationships:** Focus on providing exceptional customer service and building long-term partnerships with event organisers and venues.
- **Adapt and Innovate:** Continuously monitor emerging technologies and industry trends to adapt your offerings and stay competitive. The key is to be ready, as Brooke Byrne shared, GenAI is the new Industrial revolution for us, it’s the new steam engine for us.



5 Strategic Insights and Recommendations

5.4 FOR INDUSTRY ASSOCIATIONS

- **Become AI Literacy Hubs:** Offer comprehensive training programs and resources to help your members develop the skills needed to effectively utilise AI in their work. Cover topics like AI fundamentals, prompt engineering, and ethical considerations.
- **Advocate for Industry Recognition and Support:** Actively lobby for accurate representation of the events industry in official statistics and government frameworks. Highlight the sector's economic and social contributions, as emphasised by the discussion on the "Power of Business Events."
- **Foster Collaboration and Knowledge Sharing:** Create platforms and opportunities for event professionals to connect, share best practices, and collaborate. Facilitate discussions on key industry challenges and opportunities.
- **Support Emerging Talent:** Develop mentorship programs, scholarships, and internships, partnering with educational institutions to ensure curricula align with evolving industry needs. As Melissa Brown, CEO of ABEA, advised: "Seek out a mentor, people who can support you, who are genuinely interested, invested in your development and will hold you accountable."
- **Promote Sustainability and Ethical Practices:** Champion sustainable event practices and provide resources and guidance to help organisations implement them. Develop ethical guidelines for AI use in the events industry.
- **Membership:** As suggested by speakers, continue to create QR codes & membership information easily available.

5.5 FOR INDIVIDUAL EVENT PROFESSIONALS

- **Invest in Your "Power Skills":** Focus on developing your emotional intelligence, communication, collaboration, and critical thinking skills. These will be increasingly valuable in an AI-augmented workplace.
- **Become Fluent in the Language of Business:** Learn to articulate the ROI of events and communicate in terms of business outcomes to secure budgets and demonstrate your value. As Ian Whitworth, Founder of Scene Change, put it, "You say 'wow factor,' you're going to get peanuts. You say 'across the board savings via verifiable staff engagement KPIs'...you're suddenly looking at the big bucks."
- **Network Strategically and Build Genuine Relationships:** Attend industry events, participate in online communities, and seek out mentorship opportunities. Remember, as Darren Brown, Creative Alchemist, stated, "Every bit of work I've ever got is about the relationship."
- **Embrace Lifelong Learning:** Stay informed about emerging technologies, industry trends, and best practices. Be open to experimenting with new tools and approaches. Take the advice of Gus Balbontin, Former Lonely Planet Executive to heart: "Every year I do something that I've never done before because I don't want to lose my tolerance to change."
- **Prioritise Your Well-being:** Implement strategies to manage stress, prevent burnout, and maintain a healthy work-life balance. Take Sheila Vijayarasa's advice, and commit to daily "little brave acts", practice gratitude and adopt an "I get to" mindset.



6 About Snapsight

Snapsight is an AI-powered insights platform that transforms your organisation's content into actionable insights. We analyse event sessions, surveys, industry reports, internal documents, and more, empowering your organisation to make data-driven decisions that drive growth and innovation.

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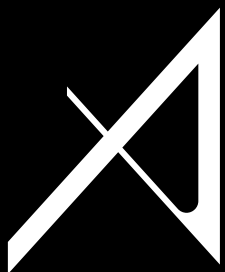
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